HOORVIA - SCREW PILOT HOLE SIZES: PRINTABLE DRILL BIT CHART

Quick Reference Cheat Sheet · US Letter Printable

Crafting & DIY · Sheet #1

Screw Gauge	Softwood Pilot	Hardwood Pilot	Best For
#4	1/16"	5/64"	Small hinges, jewelry boxes
#5	5/64"	3/32"	Light trim, small boxes
#6	3/32"	7/64"	Face frames, picture frames
#7	7/64"	1/8"	Cabinet hardware, trim
#8	1/8"	9/64"	General woodworking, decks
#9	9/64"	5/32"	Furniture joints, shelving
#10	5/32"	11/64"	Heavy furniture, framing
#12	11/64"	3/16"	Structural joints, outdoor builds
#14	3/16"	7/32"	Heavy framing, lag-style work
#16	7/32"	15/64"	Large bolts, timber framing
#18	1/4"	17/64"	Heavy timber, posts
#20	17/64"	9/32"	Maximum-duty timber joints

PRO TIP: Match the shank, not the threads: The pilot hole should match the screw's inner shank diameter. Too small and the wood splits; too large and the threads have nothing to bite.